

System Flow Diagram

Introduction

A **System Flow Diagram (SFD)** is a visual representation of how different components of a system interact, exchange data, and flow information. Unlike UML, which is often used for modeling software design and behavior, system flow diagrams focus on data movement, system interactions, and dependencies. They help stakeholders understand system architecture, integrations, and how different services and platforms communicate.

System flow diagrams are ideal for:

- Representing the flow of information between systems and services
 - Showing dependencies between platforms and tools
 - Modeling high-level system architecture for clarity and planning
 - Communicating technical workflows to non-technical audiences
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Diagram Components

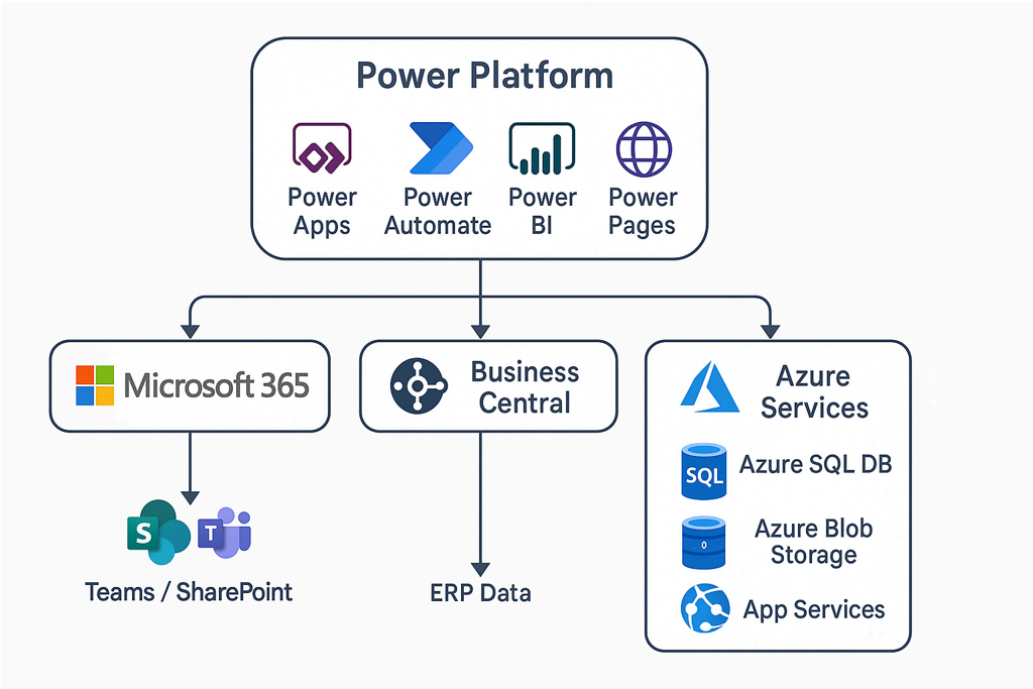
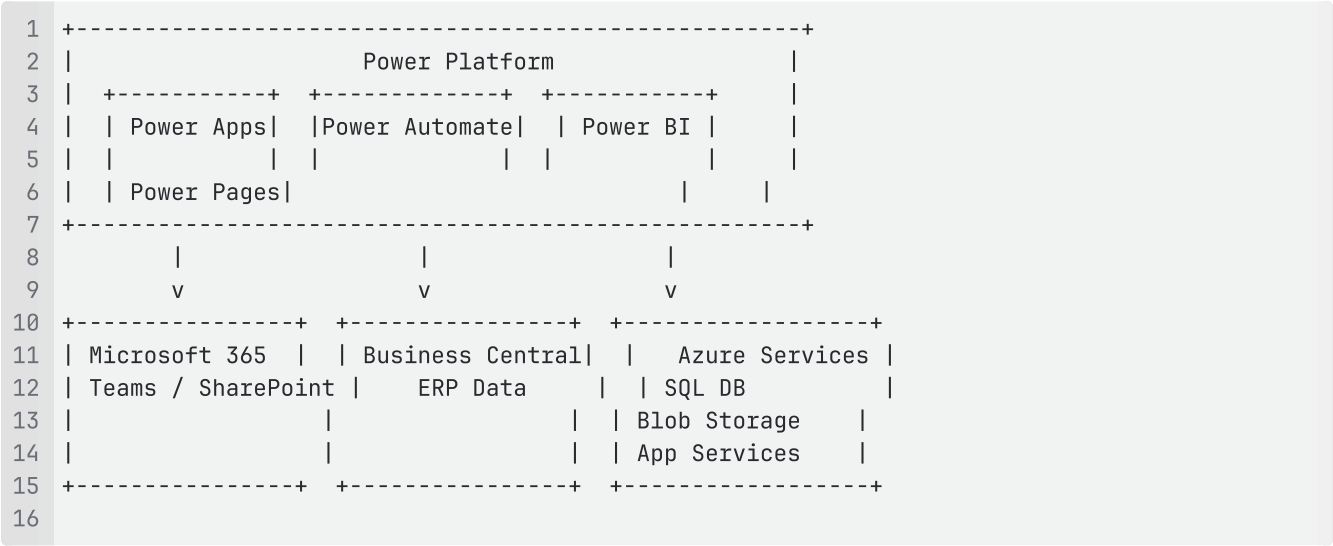
- **Systems/Platforms:** Major platforms or applications, such as Power Platform, Microsoft 365, Business Central, and Azure Services.
 - **Services:** Specific services or applications within platforms (e.g., Teams, SharePoint, Azure SQL DB).
 - **Data/Flows:** Represented by arrows showing the direction of information transfer between systems or services.
 - **Boundaries:** Boxes around systems/services indicating logical grouping or platform ownership.
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Modeling Symbol Definitions

- **Rectangles/Boxes:** Represent systems, platforms, or services.
 - **Arrows:** Show the flow of data or interactions between systems and services.
 - **Grouped Boxes:** Indicate a logical boundary (e.g., all Power Platform tools in one box, all Azure services in another).
 - **Icons/Logos:** Optional visual aids to help identify specific applications or services quickly.
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Diagram Example

System Flow Diagram – Power Platform Integration



- **Power Platform** acts as the central hub integrating Microsoft 365, Business Central, and Azure services.

- **Microsoft 365** interacts primarily through collaboration tools like Teams and SharePoint.
- **Business Central** provides ERP data used by Power Apps, Power Automate, and Power BI.
- **Azure Services** offer data storage, processing, and app hosting capabilities.